

E005

Business Productivity Software

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A production release is failing, and the eight-person support team must decide in the next ten minutes whether to roll it back. The team lead usually prefers detailed written notes, and the team just finished a long planning week. What is the best way to reach a decision?

- A. Post the question on the team wiki page.
- B. Start a quick video call or live chat with the people who must decide.
- C. Always use email for anything that affects production.
- D. Send an email and wait for replies.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Team members in five time zones need to review a proposal over the next week and leave a record of their feedback. Which approach fits best?

- A. A live meeting that everyone must attend.
- B. A series of one-on-one phone calls.
- C. Threaded comments on the shared document.
- D. Only in-person meetings count as formal feedback.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Four analysts are editing a quarterly report that runs 42 pages and includes 15 charts. They email attachments back and forth, and the team now has files named “Report_final_v3” and “Report_final_REAL.” What change best solves the problem?

- A. Split the report into 15 files, one per chart.
- B. Keep emailing, but add the date to each file name.
- C. Have one analyst print it and collect handwritten edits.
- D. Store one copy in the shared cloud workspace and co-author it with version history.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A project manager needs to share an internal budget spreadsheet with an outside vendor who only needs to review the figures. The vendor has worked with the company for six years. How should the file be shared?

- A. View-only access for anyone with the link.
- B. Full edit access, since the vendor is a long-trusted partner.
- C. Edit access for anyone with the link.
- D. View-only access for the vendor's named account.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A shared file set to “anyone with the link can edit” was changed by an unknown user. Which change most directly reduces the risk of this happening again?

- A. Make a copy and keep sharing the original.
- B. Rename the file so it is harder to find.
- C. Restrict access to named people and give edit rights only to those who need them.
- D. Permanently delete the file, since that is the only safe choice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A hardware store tracks 240 products in a spreadsheet. Cell B1 holds the 8% sales tax rate, and prices are in column A starting at A2. The formula =A2*B1 in B2 works, but when copied down to B3 it gives wrong answers. Which formula should go in B2 before copying?

- A. =\$A\$2*B1
- B. =A2*B1; copying never changes cell references.
- C. =A2*\$B\$1
- D. =SUM(A2:A240)*B1

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Cell E4 contains =\$C\$3*D4. It is copied to E5. What formula does E5 contain?

- A. =\$C\$3*D5
- B. =\$C\$4*D5
- C. =C4*D5
- D. =\$C\$3*D4

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

During a Friday afternoon training session, an analyst enters 10 in A1, 4 in B1, and 5 in C1. The formula =A1+B1*C1 is typed into D1. What value appears in D1?

- A. 30
- B. 70
- C. 19
- D. 20

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

A sales manager wants a slide showing how monthly revenue has changed over the last 24 months. The company's brand colors are navy and gold. Which chart fits best?

- A. A table listing all 24 numbers.
- B. A pie chart.
- C. A 3-D pie chart in navy and gold.
- D. A line chart.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An HR director wants to compare this year's headcount across five departments so leaders can see which is largest. Which chart fits best?

- A. A scatter plot.
- B. A bar or column chart.
- C. A line chart.
- D. A pie chart.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11.

A project team's shared task board has 45 cards and six color-coded labels. Many cards are assigned to "Team," and those tasks keep missing their dates. What change best fixes this?

- A. Discuss the tasks at the weekly meeting without changing the board.
- B. Give each card one named owner and a due date.
- C. Add more color labels to show priority.
- D. Assign every card to the whole team so everyone can help.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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12.

An account manager, the top performer on the team, wants to send client files through a free personal file-sharing app because it is faster than the company’s tool. The app has a 4.8-star rating. Company policy lists which tools are approved for client data. What should the manager do?

- A. Use the approved tool and ask IT to evaluate the new app.
- B. Use the personal app, since it is highly rated.
- C. Use the personal app only for small files.
- D. Never suggest new tools, because policies can never change.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A production release is failing, and the eight-person support team must decide in the next ten minutes whether to roll it back. ~~The team lead usually prefers detailed written notes, and the team just finished a long planning week.~~ What is the best way to reach a decision?

Target word: channel for an urgent decision **Decides:** Ten-minute deadline needs real-time back-and-forth.

A	Adjacent category	A wiki stores reference knowledge; it is not a decision channel.
B	Correct	Synchronous tools let people exchange questions and answers immediately.
C	Absolute language	No single channel fits every situation; urgency decides here.
D	Inverted operation	Email is asynchronous; replies may not arrive within ten minutes.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

Team members in five time zones need to review a proposal over the next week and leave a record of their feedback. Which approach fits best?

Target word: channel for spread-out, recorded feedback **Decides:** Different time zones plus a need for a written record.

A	Inverted operation	Five time zones make a shared live slot hard, and nothing is recorded by default.
B	Confusion set	Calls are synchronous and leave no shared record.
C	Correct	Asynchronous comments let each person respond on their own schedule and keep a record.
D	Absolute language	Written comments are a normal, valid feedback channel.

3. Answer D Concept 2

Four analysts are editing a quarterly report ~~that runs 42 pages and includes 15 charts.~~ They email attachments back and forth, and the team now has files named "Report_final_v3" and "Report_final_REAL." What change best solves the problem?

Target word: fix for version chaos **Decides:** Multiple copies are the cause.

A	Camouflage	Uses the chart count, which does not address the copies.
B	Dropped element	Still leaves many copies; only the names get better.
C	Inverted operation	Moves the team away from collaboration tools and slows everything down.
D	Correct	One file means one current version, and history allows rollback.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A project manager needs to share an internal budget spreadsheet with an outside vendor who only needs to review the figures. ~~The vendor has worked with the company for six years.~~ How should the file be shared?

Target word: sharing level **Decides:** The vendor only needs to review.

A	Dropped element	Right level, but drops the restriction to a named person.
B	Camouflage	Trust and history do not change what the vendor needs.
C	Inverted operation	Gives the most access to the widest audience.
D	Correct	Least privilege: the lowest level needed, limited to a named person.

5. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

A shared file set to “anyone with the link can edit” was changed by an unknown user. Which change most directly reduces the risk of this happening again?

Target word: fix an over-shared file **Decides:** The link setting allowed anyone to edit.

A	Adjacent category	A backup helps recovery but leaves the open link in place.
B	Confusion set	The link still works regardless of the name.
C	Correct	Applies least privilege to both audience and access level.
D	Absolute language	Fixing the sharing settings solves the problem without losing the work.

6. Answer C Concept 4

~~A hardware store tracks 240 products in a spreadsheet.~~ Cell B1 holds the 8% sales tax rate, and prices are in column A starting at A2. The formula =A2*B1 in B2 works, but when copied down to B3 it gives wrong answers. Which formula should go in B2 before copying?

Target word: lock the constant cell **Decides:** The tax-rate cell must not shift when copied.

A	Inverted operation	Locks the price, which should move, and leaves the rate free to shift.
B	Absolute language	Relative references do shift when copied; that is the bug.
C	Correct	The price reference moves row by row; the tax rate stays locked to B1.
D	Camouflage	Uses the product count to total all prices instead of fixing each row.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

Cell E4 contains =\$C\$3*D4. It is copied to E5. What formula does E5 contain?

Target word: predict the copied formula **Decides:** \$C\$3 is fully locked; D4 is relative.

A	Correct	The locked cell stays; the relative row moves down one.
B	Inverted operation	Moves the locked reference, which the \$ signs prevent.
C	Confusion set	Treats the \$ reference as if it were relative.
D	Dropped element	Forgets that the relative reference shifts.

8. Answer A Concept 5

~~During a Friday afternoon training session,~~ an analyst enters 10 in A1, 4 in B1, and 5 in C1. The formula =A1+B1*C1 is typed into D1. What value appears in D1?

Target word: formula result **Decides:** Multiplication happens before addition.

A	Correct	$4 \times 5 = 20$, then $10 + 20 = 30$.
B	Inverted operation	Works left to right: $(10 + 4) \times 5$.
C	Confusion set	Treats the * as a + and sums all three cells.
D	Dropped element	Computes only $B1 \times C1$ and drops A1.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A sales manager wants a slide showing how monthly revenue has changed over the last 24 months. ~~The company's brand colors are navy and gold.~~ Which chart fits best?

Target word: chart for a trend **Decides:** Change over time.

A	Adjacent category	A table gives exact values but hides the trend.
B	Confusion set	Pie charts show parts of a whole, not change over time.
C	Camouflage	Brand colors do not decide the chart type.
D	Correct	Line charts show movement across a time sequence.

10. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

An HR director wants to compare this year's headcount across five departments so leaders can see which is largest. Which chart fits best?

Target word: chart for comparing categories **Decides:** Categories at one point in time.

A	Adjacent category	Scatter plots show a relationship between two numeric variables.
B	Correct	Bars make size differences between categories easy to compare.
C	Inverted operation	Lines suggest a sequence over time, which departments are not.
D	Confusion set	Pies show share of a whole; close slices are hard to rank.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A project team's shared task board ~~has 45 cards and six color-coded labels.~~ Many cards are assigned to "Team," and those tasks keep missing their dates. What change best fixes this?

Target word: fix slipping tasks **Decides:** No single person owns the work.

A	Dropped element	Talks about the tasks but leaves them unowned.
B	Correct	Clear ownership makes each task someone's responsibility.
C	Camouflage	Labels sort cards but do not create ownership.
D	Inverted operation	That is the cause of the problem.

12. Answer A Concept 8

An account manager, ~~the top performer on the team,~~ wants to send client files through a free personal file-sharing app because it is faster than the company's tool. ~~The app has a 4.8 star rating.~~ Company policy lists which tools are approved for client data. What should the manager do?

Target word: action under technology policy **Decides:** Client data must stay in approved tools.

A	Correct	Follows policy now and uses the proper path to add a new tool.
B	Camouflage	Ratings do not make a tool approved for client data.
C	Adjacent category	File size does not change whether the tool is approved.
D	Absolute language	Policies can be updated through review.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Synchronous vs. asynchronous communication	Use synchronous tools (call, live chat) for urgent, back-and-forth decisions; use asynchronous tools (email, threaded comments) when people are spread out in time or a written record matters.	Using one channel for everything regardless of urgency or time zones.	A deadline in minutes vs. a review over days across time zones.
2	Single source of truth	Co-authoring one cloud file with version history beats emailing copies back and forth.	Fixing version chaos with better file names.	Files named “final_v3” or several copies in inboxes.
3	Least-privilege sharing	Share with named people at the lowest access level (view, comment, edit) they need.	Sharing “anyone with the link can edit” for convenience or trust.	An outside party who only needs to read or review.
4	Relative vs. absolute cell references	Relative references shift when copied; \$ locks the row, column, or both.	Locking the wrong cell or assuming copied formulas never change.	A single rate or constant cell used by many rows.
5	Formula order of operations	Spreadsheets multiply and divide before they add and subtract unless parentheses say otherwise.	Reading the formula strictly left to right.	A formula mixing + and * without parentheses.
6	Matching the chart to the message	Line charts show change over time; bar/column charts compare categories; pie charts show parts of one whole.	Choosing a chart for looks rather than the question it answers.	“Trend over months” vs. “compare departments.”
7	Clear task ownership	Every task needs one named owner and a due date to be tracked.	Assigning work to “the team,” which means no one owns it.	Tasks that keep slipping on a shared board.
8	Following technology policy	Use the organization’s approved tools for company data and route new tools through IT review.	Using a popular personal app because it is faster or well rated.	A personal or unapproved app handling work files.

Course scope (public description): Business Productivity Software prepares students to effectively use business productivity software to enhance efficiency, streamline communication, and support collaboration for their personal projects within an IT team setting. The course will explore a range of productivity software, including communication, collaboration, organization, and presentation software. The course covers each tool’s features and functions, how the tools contribute to optimizing productivity, and their role in facilitating clear communication and collaborative efforts. The course examines how to use these tools for productivity while following their organizations’ technology policies and best practices. There are no prerequisites for this course.